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🌻 Why causal mapping ?

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What do you think is important in social research?

Here's what we believe...

1. Social research works best when the **concepts come from people** closest to the subject — not from experts. Quantitative tools can't do that.
2. **People's worlds differ**. Not just in details — in main features. One size doesn't fit all. Especially in a changing world.
3. **Beliefs matter**. What people *think* drives what is useful when we're dealing with people — even when they're wrong.
4. Asking "**how does your world work: what influences or influenced what, for you**" can be a really useful question — for interviews and for analysis.
5. **Many of the most important questions in research and evaluation** are causal: What drives X? What does Y lead to?
6. **People are causation experts**. We make causal judgements thousands of times a day. We're the best causation detectors there are.
7. **Social research must welcome data and narratives that don't fit**: messy structure and messy contents.

☑ Causal mapping ticks all of the above boxes. How can it help in social research, concretely?

☑ Causal mapping is not an "evaluation method" but an "evidence broker" for evaluation

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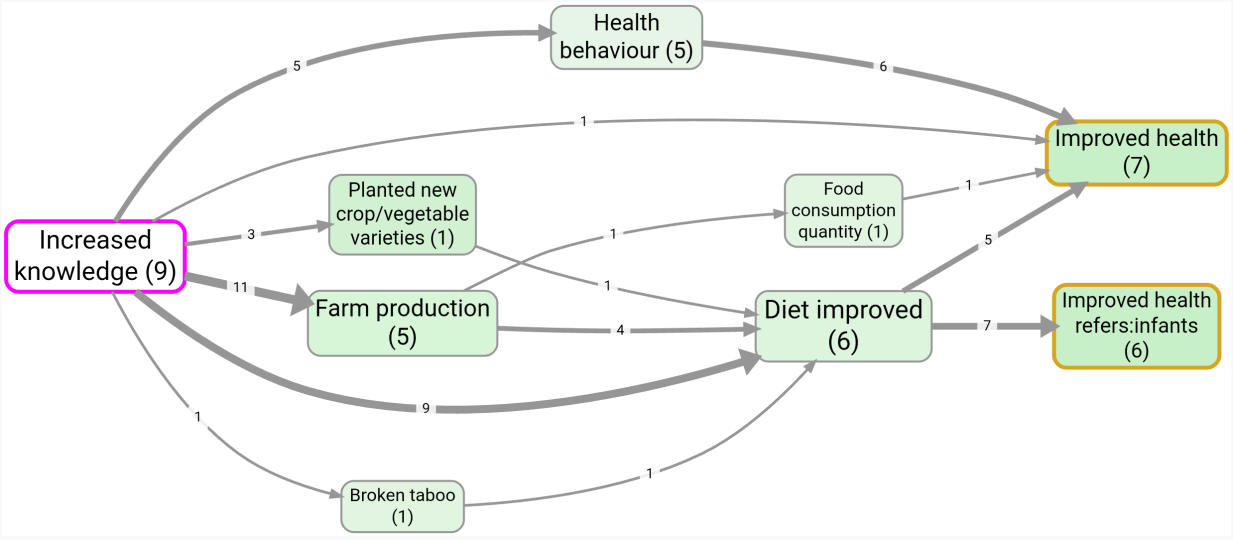
methods like QuIP, Outcome Harvesting and Process Tracing.

🤖 Causal mapping is a perfect fit to make use of the power of AI — not by using it as a block box but as a low-level coding assistant. We can apply a relatively generic causal coding template to hundreds of interviews documents and be ready to ask and answer causal questions about them very quickly.

🗺️ Stories in, stories out. People tell stories. Causal mapping takes them and outputs stories — and maps.



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